

TRAITS OF THE SPIRIT FILLED LIFE

(Sermon #1 – February 28, 2021)

TEXT: Acts 2 14-18 (KJV) *“But Peter, standing up with the eleven, lifted up his voice, and said unto them, Ye men of Judaea, and all ye that dwell at Jerusalem, be this known unto you, and hearken to my words: ¹⁵ For these are not drunken, as ye suppose, seeing it is but the third hour of the day. ¹⁶ But this is that which was spoken by the prophet Joel; ¹⁷ And it shall come to pass in the last days, saith God, I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams: ¹⁸ And on my servants and on my handmaidens I will pour out in those days of my Spirit; and they shall prophesy.”*

INTRO: According to dictionary.com the word trait means “*A distinguishing characteristic or quality, especially of one's personal nature.*”

When one becomes a Christian, many changes occur. Jesus called this change being “***Born again.***” John 3:1-8 (NKJV)
“***There was a man of the Pharisees named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews. ² This man came to Jesus by night and said to Him, “Rabbi, we know that You are a teacher come from God; for no one can do these signs that You do unless God is with him.” ³ Jesus answered and said to him, “Most assuredly, I say to you, unless one is born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God.” ⁴ Nicodemus said to Him, “How can a man be born when he is old? Can he enter a second time into his mother’s womb and be born?” ⁵ Jesus answered, “Most assuredly, I say to you, unless one is born of water and the Spirit, he cannot enter the kingdom***

of God. ⁶ That which is born of the flesh is flesh, and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit. ⁷ Do not marvel that I said to you, ‘You must be born again.’ ⁸ The wind blows where it wishes, and you hear the sound of it, but cannot tell where it comes from and where it goes. So is everyone who is born of the Spirit.” Jesus:

- Introduces the “***Born again***” experience...
- Nicodemus questions the “***Born again***” experience... (As many do)
- Jesus explains that unless one is “***Born of water and of the Spirit***” they cannot receive “***The Kingdom of God***”...
(Water = The natural birth) (Spirit = The Spiritual birth)
- Jesus also explains that those who are born of the Spirit are directed by the Spirit, much like the wind obeys the commands of God...

If one is truly “***Born again***” the thinking and nature of that individual should be affected by the born-again experience. When our lives are affected by the born-again experience, we begin to develop traits that are less like us, and more like Jesus.

When we begin to walk out the born-again experience, we are walking in SAVING FAITH. It takes faith to be saved. Romans 12:3 (KJV) “***For I say, through the grace given unto me, to every man that is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think; but to think soberly, according as God hath dealt to every man the measure of faith.***” Every one of us begin this born-again experience with exactly the same amount of faith.

I believe the Lord spoke the following to me as I was preparing this message: “***What we do with the faith we have been GIVEN, will determine what HE can do with us.***”

Saving faith is only an entry level involvement for the new believer. It is a gateway, so to speak, that allows us to begin adding the traits of Jesus to our lives, and cutting loose the characteristics of our former nature. 2 Peter 1:5-9 (NKJV) ***“Add to your faith virtue, to virtue, knowledge, ⁶ to knowledge, self-control, to self-control, perseverance, to perseverance, godliness, ⁷ to godliness brotherly kindness, and to brotherly kindness love. ⁸ For if these things are yours and abound, you will be neither barren nor unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ. ⁹ For he who lacks these things is shortsighted, even to blindness, and has forgotten that he was cleansed from his old sins.”*** What do the characteristics of the Spirit filled life look like?

- Faith...
- Virtue...
- Knowledge...
- Self-control...

- Perseverance...
- Godliness...
- Brotherly kindness...

If these traits manifest themselves in our lives:

- We will never be barren...
- We will always be fruitful...

This is certainly a process but it is a progression that should begin immediately upon conversion and end with the death or the rapture of the Christ follower.

(End of sermon#1 – February 28, 2021)

TRAITS OF THE SPIRIT FILLED LIFE

(Sermon #2 – Prayer – March 7, 2021)

TEXT: Acts 2 14-18 (KJV) *“But Peter, standing up with the eleven, lifted up his voice, and said unto them, Ye men of Judaea, and all ye that dwell at Jerusalem, be this known unto you, and hearken to my words: ¹⁵ For these are not drunken, as ye suppose, seeing it is but the third hour of the day. ¹⁶ But this is that which was spoken by the prophet Joel; ¹⁷ And it shall come to pass in the last days, saith God, I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams: ¹⁸ And on my servants and on my handmaidens I will pour out in those days of my Spirit; and they shall prophesy.”*

(Recap of last week: Born-again + operating in faith = Gateway to add traits)

An additional shift in the way a person thinks and acts should also occur when one enters into a personal relationship with Holy Spirit, called the Spirit filled life. (Explain the difference between conversion and Holy Spirit baptism – The only requirement for Holy Spirit baptism is being born-again)

I thank God for the opportunity to have been raised in a spirit filled atmosphere. Someone asked the question, “*What would you be if you were not Spirit filled?*” The answer, “*I would be disappointed.*”

The term “*Spirit filled*” has somehow received a bad name in this culture. The Spirit filled experience began on the Day of Pentecost and continues to this day. Pentecost is not some mystical thing. Pentecost simply means fiftieth day. Jesus

spent forty days on the earth after His resurrection. Ten days following His discussion with His disciples at Bethany's launching pad, the Holy Spirit filled the believers who were assembled in the Upper Room.

Since that time, all those who have received the infilling of the Holy Spirit have become known as Pentecostals, Charismatics, or Spirit filled Christians.

Being Spirit filled has received a lot of bad publicity because of:

- The excesses which have been allowed...
- The failure to demonstrate the power of the Spirit filled life...
- The legalism that has been championed...
- The quacks which have been allowed to continue...

In spite of all of this, I will tell you that there is a legitimacy to the Spirit filled life which brings with it the ability for the church to rise to a level never before achieved.

During this series of sermons, I am going to attempt to show you why living a Spirit filled life is so vital to the believer, and ultimately to the body of Christ.

Living a Spirit filled life is more than speaking in tongues, it is about four distinct things:

- Prayer...
- Power...
- Perseverance...
- Perpetuation...

TRAIT #1 - THE SPIRIT FILLED LIFE RAISES THE LEVEL OF A BELIEVER'S PRAYER LIFE!

Prayer is probably one of the most discussed and least practiced theological topics of the

church. Spirit filled people have historically been known for their praying. Someone said, *“Bent knees make straight men.” “He stands longest, who kneels lowest.”*

Jesus our great example laid out a pattern for us to follow:

- He often got up a great while before dawn and went to prayer...
- He was known to pray all night...
- He always prayed before making major decisions...
- He prayed before performing the miracle of the loaves and the fishes...
- He agonized in prayer in the garden of Gethsemane...

If Jesus was a man of prayer what makes us think we can be effective without a prayer life. If one cannot tell me what time they pray each day, I do not believe they have a prayer life. A prayer life is a matter of

fulfilling an appointment with the Heavenly Father each and every day!

Let us look to the Word to see what being filled with the Spirit does for our prayer lives. Romans 8:26-27 (KJV) ***“Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities: for we know not what we should pray for as we ought: but the Spirit itself maketh intercession for us with groanings which cannot be uttered. ²⁷ And he that searcheth the hearts knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit, because he maketh intercession for the saints according to the will of God.”***

According to this passage of Scripture when we are filled with the Holy Spirit, we receive a prayer language that:

- Engages heaven...
- Allows us to pray at a level which exceeds our vocabulary...
- Builds our faith to otherwise impossible levels...

The church I was raised in was such a powerful Spirit filled church that the prayer meetings and altar services were the main event. If you went to the altar in that church, you did not stay at the altar until you were satisfied, you stayed until they were satisfied!

Look at what the Word has to say about prayer: Luke 18:1-5 (NKJV) ***"Then He spoke a parable to them, that men always ought to pray and not lose heart,² saying:***

"There was in a certain city a judge who did not fear God nor regard man.³ "Now there was a widow in that city; and she came to him, saying, 'Get justice for me from my adversary.'⁴ "And he would not for a while; but afterward he said within himself, 'Though I do not fear God nor regard man,⁵ 'yet because this widow troubles me I will avenge her, lest by her continual coming she weary me.' "

Matthew 7:7-8 (NKJV) ***"Ask, and it will be***

given to you; seek, and you will find; knock, and it will be opened to you.⁸ “For everyone who asks receives, and he who seeks finds, and to him who knocks it will be opened.” Ephesians 6:18-20 (NKJV)

"Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, being watchful to this end with all perseverance and supplication for all the saints—19 and for me, that utterance may be given to me, that I may open my mouth boldly to make known the mystery of the gospel,²⁰ for which I am an ambassador in chains; that in it I may speak boldly, as I ought to speak."

Why is prayer such an important trait in the life of the Spirit filled believer?

- One must pray to be forgiven...
- One must pray to maintain purity...
- One must pray to walk in faith...
- One must pray to walk in freedom...
- One must pray to persevere...

- One must pray to have power with God... (The path to the miraculous leads through the prayer room!)
- One must pray to establish an intimate relationship with the Lord...

I thank God for the prayers of Spirit filled believers because:

- Spirit filled prayer brings the baptism in the Holy Spirit!
- Spirit filled prayer crucifies carnality to the cross!
- Spirit filled prayer dispels darkness!
- Spirit filled prayer eliminates evil!
- Spirit filled prayer generates joy!
- Spirit filled prayer motivates mercy!
- Spirit filled prayer neutralizes the carnal nature!
- Spirit filled prayer quiets quarrels!
- Spirit filled prayer requires a relationship with Holy Spirit!
- Spirit filled prayer unveils the unknown!

The first trait of the Spirit filled life is Holy Spirit anointed praying!

I challenge each of us to make necessary changes to our prayer life. If we are willing to do so, we can get ready to see the Lord do what He is famous for!

(End of sermon #2 – March 7, 2021)

TRAIT #2 – THE SPIRIT FILLED LIFE CAUSES THE BELIEVER TO WALK IN THE SUPERNATURAL POWER OF GOD!

(Sermon #3 – March 14, 2021)

TEXT: Acts 2 14-18 (KJV) *“But Peter, standing up with the eleven, lifted up his voice, and said unto them, Ye men of Judaea, and all ye that dwell at Jerusalem, be this known unto you, and hearken to my words: ¹⁵ For these are not drunken, as ye suppose, seeing it is but the third hour of the day. ¹⁶ But this is that which was spoken by the prophet Joel; ¹⁷ And it shall come to pass in the last days, saith God, I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams: ¹⁸ And on my servants and on my handmaidens I*

*will pour out in those days of my Spirit;
and they shall prophesy.”*

(Previous week's recap – Week 1 - Born-again + operating in faith = Gateway to add traits – Week 2 - The Spirit Filled Life Raises the Level of the Believers Prayer Life)

Since the Day of Pentecost, the Spirit filled Church has proudly championed the power of God. Today I am afraid that we are embarking upon a powerless Pentecost in this modern-day church. The New Testament church has always been, and should always be a church of power.

Listen to the words of Jesus with regard to His intentions for Spirit filled believers. Mark 16:14-18 (KJV) “*And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature. ¹⁶ He that*

believeth and is baptized shall be saved; but he that believeth not shall be damned.

¹⁷ *And these signs shall follow them that believe; In my name shall they cast out devils; they shall speak with new tongues;*

¹⁸ *They shall take up serpents; and if they drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt them; they shall lay hands on the sick, and they shall recover.*” Jesus said the “*signs that follow*” Spirit filled believers is five-fold:

- 1) “*Cast our devils...*” (I’m not one who looks for devils behind every bush, but there is far more of this to deal with, than gets dealt with in most churches – Story of one of our staff members dealing with a demon possessed girl)
- 2) “*They speak with new tongues...*” (There is more to speaking in tongues than being bilingual – Prayer language – Language of Heaven – Groanings that cannot be uttered – Build ourselves up in our most Holy faith –

Change our vocabulary and conversation)

- 3) “***Take up serpents...***” (This is not snake handling – This has to do with taking control of spirits of devils who have come to deceive and destroy)
- 4) “***Drinking deadly things...***”
(Supernatural protection – This is also a promise to shield us from doctrines of devils)
- 5) “***Lay hands on the sick and they shall recover...***” (Gifts of Healings)

Listen to what the outgrowth of walking in the power of God produces in the lives of believers. Mark 16:19 (NKJV) “***So then after the Lord had spoken unto them, he was received up into heaven, and sat on the right hand of God. ²⁰ And they went forth, and preached every where, the Lord working with them, and confirming the word with signs following. Amen.***”

- ***“The Lord went with them...”*** He will go with us!
- ***“They preached everywhere...”***
Everywhere means everywhere. Some folks are waiting for a place to preach, and the Lord is waiting on us to preach in the places He has already made available. Maybe we can’t get a door open because we haven’t accessed the ones that are already open! (Home – Business – Work – School – Bowling alley, etc)
- ***“The Lord working with them...”*** The Lord is not looking to work without us, He is looking to work with us! We are waiting on God to work and He is waiting on us to work! Maybe we will see a display of His power WHEN we start doing something.
- ***“Confirming His Word with signs following...”*** The only qualification to see His mighty power is to BELIEVE He will do it! Who is this promise to?

“These signs **SHALL** follow **THOSE WHO BELIEVE.**”

If we are Spirit filled people, where are the miracles?

The power that operates through Spirit filled Christians is unlike the power of the world. It far exceeds other powers. Other powers have limitations, but the power of Holy Spirit is unlimited.

The reason it is unlimited is because it is God-breathed.

ILLUSTRATION: (Kullman Lackey – No power greater than God’s power)

How will we ever see the power of God in operation if we do not give Him a chance to act? Mark 16:20 (NKJV) **“*They went forth, and preached every where, the Lord working with them, and confirming the*”**

word with signs following. Amen.” Every time someone mentions their need to us, we should pray for them right then and there! I encourage you to carry a small vial of oil in your pocket everywhere you go. Give God a chance to demonstrate His mighty power.

The book of Acts is commonly referred to as “*The Acts of the Apostles*,” when in reality it is really “*The Acts of the Holy Spirit*” as revealed through man.

There is no amen at the close of the book of Acts because it is still being written.

I hope we will take this sermon as a challenge to be empowered by Holy Spirit, and when we arrive in Heaven, we will discover some of our own stories have been added to the book of Acts!

I love the power of Holy Spirit:

- Because Holy Spirit brings about Holy Spirit baptism...
- Because Holy Spirit helps us preach the cross, and furnishes the power for us to carry our cross...
- Because Holy Spirit defeats all demonic power and influence...
- Because Holy Spirit can bring down empires if necessary...
- Because Holy Spirit furnishes a bright future...
- Because Holy spirit always glorifies God...
- Because Holy Spirit brings healing to the hurting...
- Because Holy Spirit crowns King Jesus...
- Because Holy Spirit produces the power of God...
- Because Holy Spirit reaches the wretches...

Acts 1:8 (KJV) *“But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth.”*

(End of sermon #3 – March 14, 2021)

**TRAIT #3 – THE SPIRIT FILLED LIFE
CAUSES THE BELIEVER TO
PERSEVERE DESPITE THE
RESISTANCE FROM THE WORLD
AND THE ENEMY!**

(Sermon #4 – March 21, 2021)

TEXT: Acts 2 14-18 (KJV) *“But Peter, standing up with the eleven, lifted up his voice, and said unto them, Ye men of Judaea, and all ye that dwell at Jerusalem, be this known unto you, and hearken to my words: ¹⁵ For these are not drunken, as ye suppose, seeing it is but the third hour of the day. ¹⁶ But this is that which was spoken by the prophet Joel; ¹⁷ And it shall come to pass in the last days, saith God, I will pour out of my Spirit upon all flesh: and your sons and your daughters shall prophesy, and your young men shall see visions, and your old men shall dream dreams: ¹⁸ And on my servants and on my handmaidens I*

*will pour out in those days of my Spirit;
and they shall prophesy.”*

(Previous week's recap – Week 1 – Born again + operating in faith = Gateway to add traits – Week 2 - The Spirit Filled Life Raises the Level of the Believers Prayer Life – Week 3 - The Spirit Filled Life Raises the Lever of the Believers Prayer Life)

The First-Century-Church was full of folks who had made up their mind to serve Jesus. I have issues with anemic, weak-willed, whiny people who claim to be Spirit filled.

When Spirit filled people are persecuted, they don't get down, they rebound! They go to Lowe's, get a ladder, and get-over-it! They shake it off and make the devil take it back!

The First-Century-Church was full of people who went the distance in spite of the odds.

Look at the perseverance of the twelve disciples:

- Andrew died on a cross...
- Simon was crucified...
- Bartholomew was flayed alive...
- James the son of Zebedee was beheaded...
- James the son of Alphaeus was beaten to death...
- Thomas was run through with a lance...
- Mathias was stoned and then beheaded...
- Matthew was slain by the sword...
- Peter was crucified upside down...
- Thaddeus was shot to death with arrows...
- Philip was hanged...
- Only John made it through alive but he was boiled in oil and exiled to a small island in the middle of the Mediterranean Sea...

Excuse me! What was our complaint or grievance? If we still have one, we should try telling it to one of the persecuted disciples of Jesus!

I thank God for Spirit filled people who are willing to persist despite the pressure to quit.

I publicly renew my commitment today to walk in victory come hell or high water!

**TRAIT #4 – THE SPIRIT FILLED LIFE
CAUSES THE BELIEVER TO
PERPETUATE ANOTHER
GENERATION OF SPIRIT FILLED
PEOPLE!**

The First-Century-Church knew how to perpetuate another generation of Spirit filled believers. Look at the results in the First Century Church:

- 3,000 were saved the first day of the church's existence in Acts 2:37-38...

- God added to the church daily such as should be saved in Acts 2:47...
- 2,000 were saved at Solomon's Porch in Acts 3:1-4...
- The Samaritans became Christians in Acts 8:1-12...
- Men and women were baptized following their conversion in Acts 8:12-13...
- The Ethiopian eunuch was converted in Acts 8:36-39...
- Saul (Paul) received Christ in Acts 9:18...
- The household of Cornelius became Christians in Acts 10:43...
- The people of Antioch were converted in Acts 11:19-21...
- Sergius Paulus became a Christian in Acts 13:4-12...
- Many Jews and religious proselytes followed Paul and Barnabas at Antioch in Acts 13:13-48...

- A great multitude of individuals followed Christ at Iconium in Acts 14:1...
- An undetermined number of people made decisions for Christ at Lystra and Derbe in Acts 14...
- The Philippian jailer and his family became followers of Christ in Acts 16...
- Lydia came to faith in Christ in Acts 16...
- A great multitude of the Greeks and many of the leading women joined themselves to the faith, at Thessalonica in Acts 17:1-12...
- The Athenians were converted at Mars Hill in Acts 17:16-34...
- Many Corinthian people were converted in Acts 18:8...
- At Corinth Aquila and Pricilla followed Jesus in Acts 18:24-28...
- The twelve disciples of John the Baptist were converted in Acts 19:1-10...

One cannot become Spirit filled through osmosis any more than a waitress will absorb food through her skin. There must be a rebirth of Spirit filled people in every generation! Just because you've attended a Spirit filled church does not mean you are Spirit filled. A fish can stay in salt water his entire life without the salt water getting in him! There are those who go through the spiritual motions of being Spirit filled, but they have never been filled with the Spirit!

Spirit filled people are constantly in the process of perpetuating another generation of Spirit filled people. Acts 1:8 (KJV) ***“But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth.”***

ILLUSTRATION: (Talk about my experience with Sister Eubanks. Sister

Eubanks created in me an insatiable desire for the things of the Spirit)

It is believed in some countries the number of Spirit filled people is now approaching thirty–five percent of the total population! I would say the Spirit filled experience is alive and well in this world.

The church has had enough figure-heads, talking-heads, hot-heads, and meat-heads. It is time for those of us who are Spirit filled to stand up and show our true colors and see revival break out in our homes, communities, and churches.

I thank God for Spirit filled perpetuation:

- For the attitudes it alters...
- For the billions it beckons...
- For the conviction it carries...
- For the demons it defies...
- For the evil it eliminates...
- For the forgiveness it finances...

- For the godless it gets right...
- For the jerks it justifies...
- For the souls it saves...
- For the sinners it sanctifies...
- For the sin problem it satisfies
- For the wickedness it washes away...

Will you join with me in doing everything possible to perpetuate another generation of Spirit filled people behind us?

(Give everyone an index card - Have them to list six names of people they will pray for every day this week – Have them to invite all six families to Easter service next week)